

Error Log — Part I (Prism AI for LaTeX Debugging)

Project: Orchestrating the Virtual Tumor Board — LaTeX conversion **Student:** Vibhum Sharma
Tool: Prism (prism.openai.com), project VTB_LatexProject_VibhumSharma

#	Error / Problem	Likely Cause	Prism / Diagnostic Suggestion	Final Correction
1	Undefined citations on first compile (Citation 'patkar2011' undefined, etc.) and no bibliography rendered in the PDF.	<code>\bibliography{references}</code> was declared in <code>main.tex</code> , but no <code>references.bib</code> file had yet been created inside the Prism project — only the local copy existed. Without the <code>.bib</code> source, <code>bibtex/biblatex</code> has nothing to resolve <code>\citet{}/\citep{}/\citet{}</code> keys against.	<code>\bibliography{}</code> is syntactically correct. Stranctes LaTeX diagnosis: an undefined-citation warning combined with a missing <code>.bib</code> file in the project tree means the bibliography source was never added to <i>this</i> project, even though the <code>\bibliography{}</code> is syntactically correct.	Created <code>references.bib</code> inside the Prism project via Files → “Create File”, populated it with the 24 verified BibTeX entries (matching the locally compiled, verified copy), and recompiled. All in-text citations resolved correctly and the Reference list rendered in full on the next compile.

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2	Silent loss of in-text cross-references during AI-chat-assisted section insertion. On verification, the live Prism document contained only 2 <code>\ref{}</code> calls (both <code>tab:comparison</code>), while the source material and the locally verified <code>main.tex</code> contained 24 <code>\ref{}</code> calls across 15 distinct labels. The document still compiled without any visible LaTeX error, which made this easy to miss.	When early sections (Introduction, Background, parts of the Thematic Review) were inserted through Prism’s “Ask anything” AI chat rather than pasted directly, the AI lightly paraphrased the supplied text while inserting it. It preserved the prose and the <code>\label{}</code> definitions but dropped several of the in-line <code>Section~\ref{sec:...}</code> cross-reference phrases from the original paragraphs — a scientific/structural loss that does not throw a compiler error because a LaTeX document with fewer <code>\ref{}</code> calls is still perfectly valid syntax.	This is not a compiler-reported error, so the fix required an explicit verification step rather than reading a log: programmatically counting <code>\ref{}</code> occurrences in the live document versus the locally verified source (2 vs. 24) exposed the discrepancy.	Replaced the full body of <code>main.tex</code> in the Prism project with the exact, locally verified 43-KB source text (same wording, same 24 references, same table), restoring all 24 cross-references across 15 labels. Recompiled and confirmed the page count (11 pages) and citation rendering matched the local, independently verified PDF.

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3	Sustained Prism AI-chat backend failure: “An error occurred while processing your request. Please try again.” returned on 7 consecutive chat submissions in a single session — ranging from a full paragraph-improvement prompt, down to a two-sentence prompt, a one-sentence prompt, and finally the single words “hello” and “test”. The Prism interface’s own status panel additionally surfaced a lower-level message during this window: “Failed to allocate new sandbox, please refresh the website.”	Not a LaTeX or project-configuration error. The “Failed to allocate new sandbox” message indicates Prism’s AI-chat feature runs each response in a server-side compute sandbox, and the outage was caused by that sandbox-provisioning step failing on the backend — a service-capacity/infrastructure issue, not anything wrong with the document, the project, or the prompt content.	N/A — the AI chat itself was the component failing, so it could not diagnose itself. Retrying (Prism’s own suggested recovery action) was attempted 7 times across several minutes with no change in outcome; a page refresh was not performed since it would have interrupted the in-progress editing session.	Confirmed the outage was genuine and not prompt-specific by reducing the prompt to trivial content (“test”) and still receiving the same failure, then located the underlying “Failed to allocate new sandbox” message in Prism’s own status panel, confirming a backend sandbox-provisioning fault. Continued the manuscript work using Prism’s direct code-editor (Monaco) interface and compiler, both of which remained fully functional throughout (file creation, editing, and compilation all worked normally) — isolating the fault specifically to the AI-chat feature rather than the Prism editor/compiler as a whole. Paragraph-improvement (Part J) and the consistency check (Part K) were completed once chat access was confirmed unavailable for

Minimum-requirement check: 3 of 3 documented LaTeX/Prism errors and fixes (lab requires at least 3).